



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computing niggles and nags are dealt with here!

Windows Rebooting With A Second Long Blue Screen

Q I have an Intel motherboard (D101GGC) with an Intel Pentium 4 processor running at 3.06 GHz, 1 GB DDR400 RAM, an XFX GeForce 8500 GT, a 40-GB Seagate IDE hard drive and a 160-GB SATA Western Digital hard drive. I use Windows XP SP3, a Frontech 450 W SMPS and a Sony DVD writer. I have installed Windows in C: drive (25 GB) on the newer hard drive. I use an older drive as a complete isolated partition for saving my music collection. Problem is when I start my computer after Windows' welcome screen, a blue screen flashes for a second with an error and then the computer restarts. The second time, it correctly starts and every thing is normal. I reinstalled XP, completely formatted my HDD, and also ran "sfc /scannow".

But the problem continues. Please help me. I have Avast Home edition, Unhack me along with Windows Defender.

Anunay Sinha

A The problem of rebooting with a quick blue screen is most likely a faulty Windows installation. Some Windows files may be corrupted. If reinstalling doesn't help, back up your data to your other drives or partitions, format and then install Windows again. The blue screen would also occur if you installed any other new hardware such as a graphic card, and if there are conflicting issues with the drivers. It could also be a faulty power supply.

Hard Disk Corruption Problems

Q I am facing problem with my hard drive. My system configuration is a 2.66-GHz Pentium 4, 1.25 GB RAM, an Intel D101GGC motherboard with ATI Radeon Xpress graphics solution having 128 MB of VRAM, 80-GB Seagate Barracuda 7200 RPM and a

Samsung DVD Writer. I have been running Windows Vista. My system has been off for around 30 days and I had kept it on sleep mode. After that, it ran well for a day. The other day, when I started Windows, it showed a problem with the Windows Sidebar. A message popped up saying Windows Sidebar is restarting. Immediately, the system restarted. Next, a black screen was visible with a message saying Unable to load winload.exe. A recent hardware or software might have caused the problem, insert Windows installation disk and repair.

I tried the same, but while repairing, it was taking extremely long—around 1hr 45 min. At that time, it was searching for Windows on the system drive. I forced a restart and since then, it has been showing errors of boot failure insert disk. I tried to format the HDD with XP, but it showed an error saying unable to format, the volume might be corrupted. It had four partitions and shows C, D, E drives as empty with only F drive in use. Has my HDD crashed? Give me a solution. How much does a new drive cost, preferably an 80 GB or a 160 GB one?

Shahnawaz Haque

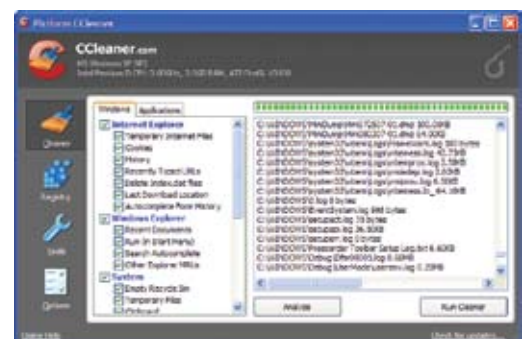
A It could be a hard drive crash. You should try connecting your hard drive to another system and see if you can recover the data. If nothing works, eventually try and use a partition manager and try removing all the partitions from the drive and create new ones. The norm currently is a 250-GB or a 320-GB hard drive. Their prices start at Rs 2,500.

Slowdown After Uninstalling Software

Q I have a system with an Intel Core 2 Duo processor, 512 MB RAM, 160-GB hard drive with Windows XP running on it. A couple of months, I installed Vista Transformation Pack 6.0 on my PC. After a month or so, I uninstalled it through Add/Remove programs in the Control Panel. Since then, my computer's performance has decreased drastically. I doubt that the pack hasn't been removed completely. How can I remove without formatting my PC? Please help!

Mayank Nandwani

A The slowdown could be from some software or drivers as well. If you think it's



CCleaner and Revo Uninstaller are standalone registry cleaners and software uninstallers.

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@thinkdigit.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Power Supply Causing Crashes

Q I have a BFG Tech 9600 GT OC graphics card. The problem is that the power requirement is a minimum of 550 W. I have a 440-W power supply that results in random crashes. I would like to buy a better power supply. Should I settle for a 650-watt supply? Please recommend a brand and the price. My PC configuration is:

Intel Core 2 Duo E6600
1 GB RAM
250-GB HDD
Gigabyte D946DZis Motherboard.

Also, I would like to know of a TFT monitor with great viewing angle, below Rs 10,000 and a good joystick option, both wireless and wired.

Sarvesh Lad

A If the power supply isn't of a good make, then the 440W PSU might actually underperform which could be causing all your instability problems. A Corsair VX450 costs around Rs 3,600 and should be easily able to run your



A good 450W system is both a reliable and fairly inexpensive purchase

system configuration. If you plan on upgrading or adding more components, then there is also a HX520 and a HX620 available, but these are priced considerably higher. Usually, 19-inch widescreen monitors are all TN-based and they aren't best known for viewing angles.

If you want a controller for racing games, a gamepad such as the Xbox 360 wired controller makes good sense. You can find it in the market at between Rs 1,400 to Rs 1,800.

the Vista transformation pack, try a stand-alone application uninstaller such as Revo Uninstaller (www.revouninstaller.com) or the one in CCleaner (www.ccleaner.com)

Vista Crashing Periodically

Q I have an HP laptop running Windows Vista Home Premium. It runs on an Intel Core 2 Duo T5450 CPU, with 1 GB RAM and a 160-GB HDD.

Whenever I close a window, I receive a message "Explorer has stopped working". After a minute, the explorer restarts and the desktop, sidebar and the Taskbar reloads. Please help me as computing has become very difficult for me with this problem.

Jainesh Patel

A It could be a problem with Windows itself. A Vista repair should be done to try and fix that problem. If nothing works, a reinstall without formatting is worth trying.

Pen Drive Disconnecting Too Often!

Q There is a problem with my pen drive. Whenever I copy a file, it shows an error and gets disconnected and then reconnects. I can't delete or even format. Is there hope? Help!

Deepak



USB drives can throw up errors due to hardware or virus problems or even physical loose connections

A The problem could be with the hardware failing. It could be a loose connection with the USB connector as well. Make sure there are no files whatsoever on the drive. Use an application called Unlocker (<http://ccollomb.free.fr/unlocker/>) to unlock any files on the drive.

Corrupted Outlook PST File

Q My PC Configuration is a 3-GHz Intel Pentium 4, 1-GB RAM and 80-GB HDD. I use Windows XP Pro SP2 along with MS Office 2003.

While using Outlook, it crashed. Now I'm unable to restore the Outlook.pst file and it gives me an error that the .pst file is damaged and it prompts me to repair the .pst file.

I tried the SCANPST utility in Office 2003 located in C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Office12\Scanpst. While processing it, it gives an error message—Microsoft Office Outlook 2003 Inbox Repair Tool. An Error has occurred, which caused the scan to be stopped. No changes have been made to the scanned file.

I have reinstalled Office 2003, but the problem persists. The Outlook.pst file is 1.96 GB. I have tried to restore this .pst file in another PC. Even there, I'm unable to restore. The same problem occurs.

Avinash Salian
Mumbai

A The Outlook file was corrupted when Outlook crashed. The SCANPST file scans the file for any corruption. If the file cannot be fixed or accessed, use a third party application such as Stellar Phoenix Outlook PST Repair (www.stellarinfo.com) or Advanced Outlook Repair (www.repair-outlook.com).